ORANGE PASSION FRUIT PRESERVES

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
2.7 kg, about 9 cups	**1 h**	**a few hours only if the apple pectin is hung in cheesecloth to drain**	**about 2 h**

INGREDIENTS

1 kg	Apples, unpeeled and uncored, each cut in eighths
1 L	Water, for the pectin
835 g	Oranges, ends off, quartered then sliced thin, about 4
330 ml	Water, for the sliced oranges
340 g	Sugar, for the sliced oranges
6 to 8	Oranges, for the supremes
1 kg	Sugar, for the final cook
285 ml	Passion fruit pulp, fresh or frozen

METHOD

1. Start with the apple pectin. Simmer the apple chunks in the 1 L of water for 30 minutes, keeping the pan at a steady simmer throughout.
2. Strain the apples through a fine-mesh sieve set over a bowl, pressing gently on the solids to drive out as much juice as they will give. For a cleaner extraction, hang the cooked fruit in cheesecloth for a few hours instead and squeeze it lightly at the end. Discard the spent apple.
3. While the apples cook, put the sliced oranges, the 330 ml of water and the 340 g of sugar in a pan. Simmer about 30 minutes, until the slices are soft and translucent.
4. Supreme the remaining oranges. Cut the ends off one, stand it on a flat end, and pare the peel and white pith away in strips with a sharp paring knife, following the curve of the fruit until none is left.
5. Cut in along each membrane to release the segments and drop them into a bowl. Work through the other oranges the same way, then squeeze the stripped peels over the bowl before throwing them out. You want 680 g, roughly 3 cups, of segments.
6. Put everything in a large saucepan together — apple pectin, cooked orange slices, segments and their juice, the 1 kg of sugar, the passion fruit pulp.
7. Cook over medium heat, stirring with a wooden spoon, until the preserve reaches 221F [105C]. Ladle the foam off the surface as it gathers and discard it.

NOTES

Three preparations feed into one pan. The orange slices go on while the apples simmer, which keeps the whole thing to about two hours.
Apples go in unpeeled and uncored on purpose — the peel and core hold most of the pectin, and the recipe has no commercial pectin in it.
221F [105C] is the set point. Jar the preserve below that and it stays syrupy.
Fresh passion fruit brings its seeds with it. Take out some or all of them unless you want a very crunchy preserve.
The yield is large, 2.7 kg, so have the jars washed and lined up before the final cook starts.
Use the 1 kg and ignore the volume figure. The source prints the final cook's sugar as both 10 cups and 1 kg, which cannot both be right, since 1 kg of sugar is 5 cups. The weight is the correct one. A set at 221F wants roughly 65% soluble solids, so this 2.7 kg yield needs about 1755 g of solids, the fruit brings around 180 g of its own sugar, and 340 g is already spoken for by the orange slices. That leaves about 1.2 kg for the final cook, which is where the 1 kg lands. Ten cups would make sugar 87% of the finished weight, which is candy rather than a spread and will not fit alongside 1.8 kg of fruit.

PRESERVING

Spoon the hot preserve into jars, leaving 4 to 6 mm [1/8 to 1/4 in] of headspace, fit the lids, and process according to the instructions for your canner.
Jars that have been processed hold at room temperature up to 1 year.
To skip processing, let the filled jars cool and then refrigerate them up to 10 days or freeze them up to 1 month.